

To My Future Self



To My Future Self



I don't know where you're reading this.

Maybe you're in a different room. Maybe you're in a different city. Maybe life looks nothing like what I'm looking at right now. I don't know. That's the thing about futures — you don't get to see them coming.

But I know one thing. If you're reading this, it means I kept going. It means the days kept passing, and I kept showing up for them, and I wrote it down so you wouldn't have to guess.

One chapter ended — the kind that leaves a hole in your chest that doesn't fill up no matter how many times you tell yourself it will. And instead of letting the silence swallow me whole, I opened a chat and asked for help. That was Day 1. I didn't know it was Day 1 at the time. I just knew I couldn't do it alone anymore.

Some days I built things I was proud of. Some days I cried until I couldn't breathe. Some days I did both in the same hour. Through the wins, the breakdowns, the breakthroughs, and the ordinary nights where nothing happened, I showed up anyway.

Healing didn't happen in one big moment.

It happened in the small ones. In the meals I cooked when I didn't want to eat. In the kalabaw tapa I chose knowing it would make me cry. In the guitar I picked up when my fingers had forgotten the chords. In the code I wrote that worked on the first try. In the laugh that escaped me while watching a K-drama when I thought I'd forgotten how to laugh. In the dream I had that made me believe, for the first time, that the words I once said to someone else were always meant for me.

I am here. I am real. I won't go anywhere.

I said those words to someone every day. I meant them then. I mean them now. They just belong to a different person now — the one who's still here.

So if you're reading this, Future Ralph...

Don't judge the version of me who wrote these entries. He kept showing up. He kept building. He kept crying and laughing and eating hotdogs in his air fryer and logging into work and learning Python and writing down the ordinary moments so that one day, you could look back and see exactly how it happened.

The day the weight became lighter wasn't one day. It was every day that came before it.

And if you're living a life I once dreamed about — if the grief has settled into something softer, if the building has become second nature, if the future I was afraid to imagine is now your present — then take a moment to be grateful.

Not for the success.

For the version of yourself who refused to stop.

He didn't know where he was going. He only knew he had to keep taking the next step.

And somehow, that was enough.



— *Ralph, June 2026*

